Tetzaveh 5784 (1)

פרשת תצוה is unique, as the בעל הטורים points out, because it is one of the rare פרשיות after the birth of משה רבינו where his name is not mentioned. Everyone is familiar with the מדרש which explains that this is due to משה רבינו's statement (32:32) מְחֵנִי נָא מִסִּפְרְךָ. A קללת חכם, even if made על תנאי, is מתקיים.

There is much discussion as to why this specifically happens in פרשת תצוה. A well-known answer is that it almost always coincides with ז' אדר, the yartzeit of משה רבינו. Why this connection exists is an interesting שאלה on its own. However, I'd like to focus on something else.

I haven't counted how many times, but the word ואתה appears numerous times throughout פרשת תצוה. The first word of the פרשה itself is ואתה, with הקדוש ברוך הוא speaking directly to משה רבינו. This is remarkable when you think about it because we often take for granted the direct communication between הקדוש ברוך הוא and משה רבינו. From beginning to end, it's ועשית, וצפית, ונתת, followed by ואתה, ואתה, ואתה - constant dialogue between הקדוש ברוך הוא and משה רבינו.

The first מצוה in פרשת תצוה is (27:20) שֶׁמֶן זַיִת זָךְ כָּתִית לַמָּאוֹר לְהַעֲלֹת נֵר תָּמִיד. The idea of תמיד is central here. Interestingly, the final section of the פרשה discusses the מזבח הזהב, the golden מזבח for קטורת. The קטורת was brought every single day, בבוקר, בבוקר, but the מזבח הזהב also had another function: once a year on יום כיפור, as the פסוק states (30:10): וְכִפֶּר אַהֲרֹן עַל קַרְנֹתָיו אַחַת בַּשָּׁנָה מִדַּם חַטַּאת הַכִּפֻּרִים אַחַת בַּשָּׁנָה. Even though this was a once-a-year event, it held an element of תמיד, of constancy, reinforcing the central theme of this פרשה.

In English, להבדיל, we use the term "constant," but there's another crucial word: "consistent." Our relationship with הקדוש ברוך הוא must be consistent - no breaks, no moments of stepping away by saying, "I'll be back soon." Everything revolves around maintaining a continuous, consistent connection with הקדוש ברוך הוא.

This is the message of the פרשה: לְהַעֲלֹת נֵר תָּמִיד - הקדוש ברוך הוא's light is upon us at all times. Our עבודה must be one of אֶת הַכֶּבֶשׂ הָאֶחָד תַּעֲשֶׂה בַבֹּקֶר וְאֵת הַכֶּבֶשׂ הַשֵּׁנִי תַּעֲשֶׂה בֵּין הָעַרְבָּיִם - constantly and consistently. The highest form of that was the עבודה of יום כיפור, which again, was a constant עבודה for דור דורות, even though it only happened once a year. That is the message of the פרשה: משה רבינו's name is not there, but his presence is there very consistently, ואתה, ואתה, ואתה. משה רבינו is constantly representing us before הקדוש ברוך הוא, constantly bringing us back to Hashem, constantly reminding us of what our עבודה is, and we should be successful in that לדור דורות.

https://youtu.be/LdjrVMKrUzk